Generic low-code platforms cannot be directly used to build low-level products like in-memory grids, Big Data processing algorithms, image recognition, etc. However, over the years they have evolved a lot to cover the widest range of capabilities for enterprise-grade development and full life cycle management, including business process management (BPM), integration workflows, UIs, business logic, data models, Web services, and APIs. They enable high-productivity development and a faster time to market for all types of developers. They also help create applications of any complexity including enterprise applications with generic architectures and complex backends, using microservices and service bus.

Figure 1 illustrates some of the key use cases that have been influenced positively in terms of productivity, scale and quality by leveraging low-code platforms.

Enable cross-functional team collaboration: Any product development needs a combination of business or functional experts as well as professional developers. Low-code platforms provide features that are relevant to a business user as well as professional developer. Cross-functional teams can leverage these platforms to turn great business ideas into readily deployable products much faster.

Rapid digital transformation of existing product suites: By leveraging client and server-side APIs of the platform, developers will be able to build, package and distribute new functionalities, such as connectors to external services like machine learning and AI. Low-code platforms enable developers to push beyond the boundaries of the core platform to build better solutions faster by extending the native features of the platform with some code.

Help meet sudden spikes in demand: Automated code generation combined with the one-click deployment option of low-code platforms helps in quicker product customisations, as well as building product variants and burning backlog of features faster.

Help build MVPs at a rapid rate: The end-to-end development and operational tools in low-code platforms provide a cohesive ecosystem that allows an enterprise to rapidly bring products to life and manage the entire SDLC process. They are used to build quick MVPs or PoCs for technology, frameworks, and architecture or for feature evaluation.

Support cloud scale architecture and design: Low-code platforms provide flexible microservices

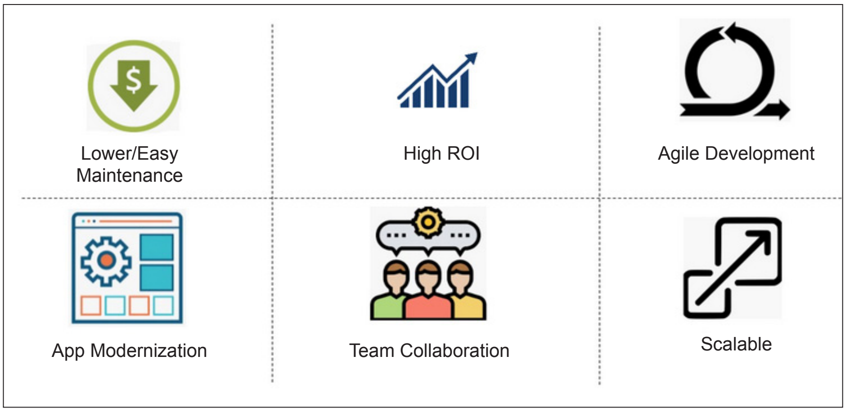

Figure 2: Benefits of low-code platforms

Table 1

Evaluation criteria	Description
Functional features	Productivity, UI flexibility, ease of use
Cloud and containerisation	Capability to utilise popular cloud providers services like serverless, AI/ML, blockchain, etc
CI/CD integration	Out-of-the-box support for automation and CI/CD toolchain
Integration capabilities	REST and cloud app support, ability to connect to different SQL and NoSQL databases
Performance	Parallel and batch execution with support for elastic scalability
Security	Enable security by design: security tools, development methods, and governance tooling
Language support	Support for popular languages like Java, .NET, Python, etc
Development methodologies	Support standard Agile development methodologies like Scrum, XP, Kanban, etc
Extensibility	Ability to extend features of existing applications
Others	Platform support, learning curve, documentation, etc